

Jiarui Hai

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[LinkedIn](#) | [Github](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

RESEARCH INTEREST

My research interests center on AI for speech and audio signal processing, with a particular emphasis on integrating natural language prompting and reasoning. They include text-to-audio and text-to-voice generation, text-to-speech synthesis, text-guided source separation, and audio understanding tasks such as general audio question answering and text-guided sound event detection.

In addition, my passion and experience in music production drive a side interest in music technology, especially in music generation, transcription, source separation and restoration, and singing voice synthesis.

EDUCATION

- Johns Hopkins University** Baltimore, MD, USA
Ph.D Candidate in Electrical and Computer Engineering Aug 2022 - Expected 2026
Advisor: Mounya Elhilali
- Tsinghua University** Beijing, China
M.E. in Civil Engineering Aug 2020 - Jun 2022
Member in Big Data Program
- Tsinghua University** Beijing, China
B.E. in Civil Engineering Aug 2016 - Jun 2020
B.S. in Business Analytics

EXPERIENCE

- Adobe CAVA | Speech AI Lab** San Francisco, CA, USA
Research Intern | Supervisors: Ke Chen, Rithesh Kumar, Zeyu Jin May 2025 - Present
Research Topic: Speech Synthesis
- Johns Hopkins University | LCAP** Baltimore, MD, USA
Research Assistant | Supervisor: Mounya Elhilali Aug 2022 - Present
Research Topic: Audio Generation and Understanding
- Tencent AI Lab | Speech Group** Bellevue, WA, USA
Research Intern | Supervisors: Yong Xu, Hao Zhang, Dong Yu May 2024 - Aug 2024
Research Topic: Audio Generation
- Kuaishou | AI Platform** Beijing, China
Algorithm Engineer Intern | Supervisors: Rui Lu, Zhiyao Duan Jun 2020 - Jun 2021
Research Topic: Singing Voice Synthesis
- University of Hong Kong | Business School** Hongkong, China
Research Assistant | Supervisor: Hailiang Chen Jun 2019 - Sep 2019
Research Topic: Causal Analysis

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

FULL LIST AVAILABLE ON [GOOGLE SCHOLAR](#)

- [12] **Jiarui Hai**, Helin Wang, Mounya Elhilali. "FlexSED: Towards Open-Vocabulary Sound Event Detection". WASPAA 2025.
- [11] **Jiarui Hai**, Mounya Elhilali. "SynSonic: Augmenting Sound Event Detection through Text-to-Audio Diffusion ControlNet and Effective Sample Filtering". WASPAA 2025.
- [10] Yongyi Zang, **Jiarui Hai**, Wanying Ge, Helin Wang, Zheqi Dai, Yuki Mitsufuji, Qiuqiang Kong, Mark Plumbley. "The Inaugural Music Source Restoration Challenge". ICASSP 2026 Grand Challenge.
- [9] Helin Wang*, **Jiarui Hai***, Dading Chong, Karan Thakkar, Tiantian Feng, Dongchao Yang, Junhyeok Lee, Laureano Moro Velazquez, Jesus Villalba, Zengyi Qin, Shrikanth Narayanan, Mounya Elhiali, Najim Dehak. "CapSpeech: Enabling Downstream Applications in Style-Captioned Text-to-Speech". Preprint.
- [8] Helin Wang, **Jiarui Hai**, Dongchao Yang, Chen Chen, Kai Li, Junyi Peng, Thomas Thebaud, Laureano Moro-Velazquez, Jesus Villalba, Najim Dehak. "SoloSpeech: Enhancing Intelligibility and Quality in Target Speech Extraction through a Cascaded Generative Pipeline". Preprint.
- [7] **Jiarui Hai**, Yong Xu, Hao Zhang, Chenxing Li, Helin Wang, Mounya Elhilali, Dong Yu. "EzAudio: Enhancing Text-to-Audio Generation with Efficient Diffusion Transformer". Interspeech 2025 (Oral).
- [6] Helin Wang*, **Jiarui Hai***, Yen-Ju Lu, Karan Thakkar, Mounya Elhilali, Najim Dehak. "SoloAudio: Target Sound Extraction with Language-oriented Audio Diffusion Transformer". ICASSP 2025.
- [5] **Jiarui Hai***, Karan Thakkar*, Helin Wang, Zengyi Qin, Mounya Elhilali. "DreamVoice: Text-Guided Voice Conversion". Interspeech 2024.

- [4] **Jiarui Hai***, Helin Wang*, Dongchao Yang, Karan Thakkar, Najim Dehak, Mounya Elhilali. "DPM-TSE: A Diffusion Probabilistic Model for Target Sound Extraction". ICASSP 2024.
- [3] **Jiarui Hai***, Yu-jeh Liu*, Mounya Elhilali. "Boosting Modality Representation with Pre-trained Models and Multi-task Training for Multimodal Sentiment Analysis". ASRU 2023.
- [2] **Jiarui Hai**, Mounya Elhilali. "Diff-Pitcher: Diffusion-based Singing Voice Pitch Correction". WASPAA 2023 (**Oral**).
- [1] Rui Lu, Baigong Zheng, **Jiarui Hai**, Fei Tao, Zhiyao Duan, Ji Liu. "Progressive Teacher-Student Training Framework for Music Tagging". ICASSP 2022.

RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

- **Peer Reviewer**
 - Journal: IJCV
 - Conference: ICASSP, InterSpeech, WASPAA, ASRU, SLT
 - Workshop: DeLTa @ ICLR 2025, Audio Imagination @ NeurIPS 2024
- **Open-source Contribution**
 - OpenSound: <https://huggingface.co/OpenSound>
 - MeanFlow-Pytorch: <https://github.com/haidog-yaqub/MeanFlow>
- **Datasets, Benchmarks, and Challenges**
 - Music Source Restoration Challenge: <https://msrchallenge.com/>
 - CapSpeech (General Speech Caption Dataset): <https://wanghelin1997.github.io/CapSpeech-demo/>
 - DreamVoice (Voice Timbre Dataset): https://haidog-yaqub.github.io/dreamvoice_demo/

MUSIC ACTIVITIES

- **Professional Recognition**
 - Top New Producer Award, BeatsHome Hip-hop Production Contest | Apr 2021
 - Invited Lecture on Music Production, Modern Sky (Chinas leading music company) | Jun 2021
 - Featured Producer on a rap single showcased in HIPHOP BANK (TV show, China) | Aug 2021
- **Creative & Media Activities**
 - Independent Artist & Beatmaker: produce singles and beat tapes
 - Content Creator: share tutorials on music production and mixing
- **Leadership and Co-founder**
 - President, Rap & HipHop Association, Tsinghua University | 2020–2021
 - Co-founder, InnerSup Records (Music Producer Team)
 - Co-founder, Music Production Team, Rap & HipHop Association, Tsinghua University